The Low-Energy House

Living with chronic illness without self-abandonment.

A FIELD GUIDE FOR PACING AND VARIABLE CAPACITY

01 The condition

Capacity that changes from day to day, sometimes hour to hour, without asking first. A good day spent in full, and two days paying for it. A calendar built for a body that shows up the same every morning.

From the outside, this can look like inconsistency. From the inside, it is a body keeping its own accounts, and sending the bill whether or not you agreed to the purchase.

Pacing starts from a different place. Instead of planning for the day you hope to have, you plan for the range of days you actually get, and decide in advance what each one can hold.

02 How to use this sample

Fill in the page that follows on a fuller day, when deciding is easier. Use it on a low one, when deciding is the expensive part. Keep it somewhere you can see it without opening anything.

This guide describes lived strategies, not medical advice. Pacing works best alongside the clinician who knows your condition.

03 Three versions of today

Write what each kind of day can realistically hold. Be honest about the low column. It is the one that does the most work.

	LOW DAY	MIDDLE DAY	FULLER DAY
Must happen			
Can wait			
Can be someone else's			
Rest that actually counts			

How does a low day announce itself before it arrives? (My early signs)

One thing I will stop doing on low days, starting this week

THE FULL FIELD GUIDE

This is a two-page sample of *The Low-Energy House*, a 17-page field guide. The full version also holds:

— Pacing, spoons, and the arithmetic of a fluctuating week
— Language for limits at work and at home
— Arranging the house so ordinary tasks cost less
— Talking with people who only see your good days

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